
INTERNATIONAL AS ENGLISH LITERATURE

Unit 1 Aspects of dramatic tragedy

Wednesday 3 January 2024

07:00 GMT

Time allowed: 2 hours

Materials

For this paper you must have:

- an OxfordAQA 12-page Answer book.

Instructions

- Use black ink or black ball-point pen.
- Write the information required on the front of your answer book.
- Do all rough work in your answer book. Cross through any work you do not want to be marked.
- You must answer **one** question from Section A and **one** question from Section B.
- Remember to include, in both your answers, relevant comments on the authors' dramatic methods in the set texts you are studying.

Information

- The maximum mark for this paper is 50.
- The marks for questions are shown in brackets.
- You will be marked on your ability to:
 - use good English
 - organise information clearly
 - analyse carefully the writers' methods
 - use specialist vocabulary where appropriate.

Section A: Elizabethan and Jacobean tragedy

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0	1
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William Shakespeare: *Othello*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Othello and Emilia
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 5 Scene 2**DESDEMONA**

O, falsely, falsely murdered!

EMILIA

Alas, what cry is that?

OTHELLO

That? What?

EMILIA

Out, and alas! that was my lady's voice.
Help! help, ho! help! O lady, speak again!
Sweet Desdemona! O sweet mistress, speak!

DESDEMONA

A guiltless death I die.

EMILIA

O, who hath done this deed?

DESDEMONA

Nobody – I myself. Farewell –
Commend me to my kind lord – O, farewell!

[She dies]

OTHELLO

Why, how should she be murdered?

EMILIA

Alas, who knows?

OTHELLO

You heard her say herself, it was not I.

EMILIA

She said so: I must needs report the truth.

OTHELLO

She's, like a liar, gone to burning hell: 'Twas I that kill'd her.

EMILIA

O, the more angel she,
And you the blacker devil!

OTHELLO

She turned to folly, and she was a whore.

EMILIA

Thou dost belie her, and thou art a devil.

OTHELLO

She was false as water.

EMILIA

Thou art rash as fire, to say
That she was false: O, she was heavenly true!

OTHELLO

Cassio did tup her; ask thy husband else.
O, I were damned beneath all depth in hell,
But that I did proceed upon just grounds
To this extremity. Thy husband knew it all.

EMILIA

My husband!

OTHELLO

Thy husband.

EMILIA

That she was false to wedlock?

OTHELLO

Ay, with Cassio. Nay, had she been true,
If heaven would make me such another world
Of one entire and perfect chrysolite,
I'd not have sold her for it.

EMILIA

My husband!

OTHELLO

Ay, 'twas he that told me on her first:
An honest man he is, and hates the slime
That sticks on filthy deeds.

This extract continues on the next page

EMILIA

My husband!

OTHELLO

What needs this iteration, woman? I say thy husband.

EMILIA

O mistress, villainy hath made mocks with love:
My husband say that she was false!

OTHELLO

He, woman; I say thy husband – dost understand the word? –
My friend, thy husband, honest, honest Iago.

EMILIA

If he say so, may his pernicious soul
Rot half a grain a day! He lies to the heart:
She was too fond of her most filthy bargain.

OTHELLO

Ha!

EMILIA

Do thy worst: This deed of thine is no more worthy heaven
Than thou wast worthy her.

OTHELLO

Peace, you were best.

EMILIA

Thou hast not half that power to do me harm
As I have to be hurt. O gull! O dolt!
As ignorant as dirt! thou hast done a deed –
I care not for thy sword, I'll make thee known,
Though I lost twenty lives: Help! help, ho! help!
The Moor hath killed my mistress! Murder! murder!

Turn over for the next question

or

0	2
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William Shakespeare: *King Lear*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Edmund, Edgar and Albany
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 5 Scene 3

EDMUND

What you have charged me with, that have I done;
And more, much more. The time will bring it out:
'Tis past, and so am I. [*To Edgar*] But what art thou
That hast this fortune on me? If thou be'st noble,
I do forgive thee.

EDGAR

Let's exchange charity.
I am no less in blood than thou art, Edmund,
If more, the more ignobly thou hast wronged me.
My name is Edgar, and thy father's son.
The gods are just, and of our pleasant vices
Make instruments to scourge us:
The dark and vicious place where thee he got
Cost him his eyes.

EDMUND

Thou hast spoken truth. The wheel is come full circle, I am here.

ALBANY [*to Edgar*]

Methought thy very gait did prophesy
A royal nobleness. I must embrace thee.
Let sorrow split my heart, if I did ever hate
Thee or thy father!

EDGAR

Worthy prince, I know't.

ALBANY

Where have you hid yourself?
How have you known the miseries of your father?

EDGAR

By nursing them, my lord. List a brief tale,
And when 'tis told, O, that my heart would burst!
The bloody proclamation to escape,
That followed me so near – O, our lives' sweetness!
That we the pain of death would hourly die
Rather than die at once – taught me to shift
Into a madman's rags, to assume a semblance
That very dogs disdain'd; and in this habit
Met I my father with his bleeding rings,
Their precious stones new-lost: became his guide,
Led him, begged for him, saved him from despair;
Never – O father! – revealed myself unto him,
Until some half hour past, when I was armed:
Not sure, though hoping, of this good success,
I asked his blessing, and from first to last
Told him my pilgrimage, but his flawed heart,
Alack, too weak the conflict to support –
'Twixt two extremes of passion, joy and grief,
Burst smilingly.

EDMUND

This speech of yours hath moved me,
And shall perchance do good. But speak you on;
You look as you had something more to say.

ALBANY

If there be more, more woeful, hold it in,
For I am almost ready to dissolve,
Hearing of this.

EDGAR

This would have seemed a period
To such as love not sorrow; but another,
To amplify, too much would make much more,
And top extremity.
Whilst I was big in clamour came there in a man,
Who, having seen me in my worst estate,
Shunn'd my abhorred society; but then, finding
Who 'twas that so endured, with his strong arms
He fastened on my neck, and bellowed out
As he'd burst heaven; threw him on my father;
Told the most piteous tale of Lear and him
That ever ear received, which in recounting
His grief grew puissant and the strings of life
Began to crack. Twice then the trumpets sounded,
And there I left him tranced.

Turn over for the next question

or

0	3
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William Shakespeare: *Hamlet*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of the different characters
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 5 Scene 1

HAMLET [*coming forward*]

What is he whose grief
Bears such an emphasis, whose phrase of sorrow
Conjures the wandering stars, and makes them stand
Like wonder-wounded hearers? This is I,
Hamlet the Dane.

[*He leaps in after Laertes*]

LAERTES [*grappling with him*] The devil take thy soul!

HAMLET

Thou pray'st not well.
I prithee take thy fingers from my throat;
For though I am not splenative and rash,
Yet have I something in me dangerous,
Which let thy wiseness fear. Away thy hand.

CLAUDIUS

Pluck them asunder.

GERTRUDE

Hamlet, Hamlet!

ALL THE LORDS

Gentlemen!

HORATIO

Good my lord, be quiet.

[*The attendants part them*]

HAMLET

Why I will fight with him upon this theme
Until my eyelids will no longer wag.

GERTRUDE

O my son, what theme?

HAMLET

I loved Ophelia. Forty thousand brothers
 Could not, with all their quantity of love,
 Make up my sum – What wilt thou do for her?

CLAUDIUS

O, he is mad, Laertes.

GERTRUDE

For love of God, forbear him.

HAMLET

'Swounds, show me what thou'lt do:
 Woo't weep? Woo't fight? Woo't fast? Woo't tear thyself?
 Woo't drink up eisel, eat a crocodile?
 I'll do't. Dost thou come here to whine,
 To outface me with leaping in her grave?
 Be buried quick with her, and so will I.
 And, if thou prate of mountains, let them throw
 Millions of acres on us, till our ground,
 Singeing his pate against the burning zone,
 Make Ossa like a wart! Nay, an thou'lt mouth,
 I'll rant as well as thou.

CLAUDIUS

This is mere madness:
 And thus awhile the fit will work on him;
 Anon, as patient as the female dove,
 When that her golden couplets are disclosed,
 His silence will sit drooping.

HAMLET

Hear you, sir;
 What is the reason that you use me thus?
 I loved you ever. But it is no matter;
 Let Hercules himself do what he may,
 The cat will mew and dog will have his day.

[*Exit*]

CLAUDIUS

I pray you, good Horatio, wait upon him. [*Exit Horatio*]
 [*To Laertes*] Strengthen your patience in our last night's speech;
 We'll put the matter to the present push. –
 Good Gertrude, set some watch over your son.
 This grave shall have a living monument.
 An hour of quiet shortly shall we see;
 Till then, in patience our proceeding be.

[*Exeunt*]

Turn over for the next question

or

0	4
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Christopher Marlowe: *Doctor Faustus*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Faustus and the Horse-courser
- Marlowe's use of dramatic language
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 4 Scene 4

[Enter Faustus, a Horse-courser and Mephistopheles.]

HORSE-COURSER

I beseech your worship, accept of these forty dollars.

FAUSTUS

Friend, thou canst not buy so good a horse for so small a price. I have no great need to sell him: but, if thou likest him for ten dollars more, take him, because I see thou hast a good mind to him.

HORSE-COURSER

I beseech you, sir, accept of this: I am a very poor man, and have lost very much of late by horse-flesh, and this bargain will set me up again.

FAUSTUS

Well, I will not stand with thee: give me the money *[Horse-courser gives Faustus the money]*. Now, sirrah, I must tell you that you may ride him o'er hedge and ditch, and spare him not; but, do you hear? in any case, ride him not into the water.

HORSE-COURSER

How, sir! not into the water! why, will he not drink of all waters?

FAUSTUS

Yes, he will drink of all waters; but ride him not into the water: o'er hedge and ditch, or where thou wilt, but not into the water. Go, bid the ostler deliver him unto you, and remember what I say.

HORSE-COURSER

I warrant you, sir! — O, joyful day! now am I a made man for ever.

[Exit]

FAUSTUS

What art thou, Faustus, but a man condemned to die?
 Thy fatal time draws to a final end.
 Despair doth drive distrust into my thoughts:
 Confound these passions with a quiet sleep:
 Tush, Christ did call the thief upon the Cross;
 Then rest thee, Faustus, quiet in conceit.

[He sits to sleep. Re-enter the Horse-courser, wet.]

HORSE-COURSER

O, what a cozening doctor was this! I, riding my horse into the water, thinking some hidden mystery had been in the horse, I had nothing under me but a little straw, and had much ado to escape drowning. Well, I'll go rouse him, and make him give me my forty dollars again. — Ho, sirrah Doctor, you cozening scab! Master Doctor, awake, and rise, and give me my money again, for your horse is turned to a bottle of hay, Master Doctor!
[He pulls off his leg]. Alas, I am undone! what shall I do? I have pulled off his leg.

FAUSTUS

O, help, help! the villain hath murdered me.

HORSE-COURSER

Murder or not murder, now he has but one leg, I'll outrun him, and cast this leg into some ditch or other.

[Exit Horse-courser with the leg]

FAUSTUS

Stop him, stop him, stop him! — Ha, ha, ha! Faustus hath his leg again, and the Horse-courser a bundle of hay for his forty dollars.

[Enter Wagner]

How now, Wagner! what news with thee?

WAGNER

If it please you, the Duke of Vanholt doth earnestly entreat your company, and hath sent some of his men to attend you, with provision fit for your journey.

FAUSTUS

The Duke of Vanholt's an honourable gentleman, and one to whom I must be no niggard of my cunning. Come, away!

[Exeunt]

Turn over for the next question

or

0	5
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John Webster: *The Duchess of Malfi*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Bosola, the Cardinal and Ferdinand
- Webster's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 1 Scene 1

CARDINAL

Be sure you entertain that Bosola
For your intelligence. I would not be seen in't;
And therefore many times I have slighted him
When he did court our furtherance, as this morning.

FERDINAND

Antonio, the great-master of her household,
Had been far fitter.

CARDINAL

You are deceived in him.
His nature is too honest for such business.
He comes: I'll leave you.
[Exit]

[Re-enter Bosola]

BOSOLA

I was lured to you.

FERDINAND

My brother, here, the Cardinal, could never
Abide you.

BOSOLA

Never since he was in my debt.

FERDINAND

May be some oblique character in your face
Made him suspect you.

BOSOLA

Doth he study physiognomy?
There's no more credit to be given to the face
Than to a sick man's urine, which some call
The physician's whore, because she cozens him.
He did suspect me wrongfully.

FERDINAND

For that
You must give great men leave to take their times.
Distrust doth cause us seldom be deceived.
You see the oft shaking of the cedar-tree
Fastens it more at root.

BOSOLA

Yet take heed;
For to suspect a friend unworthily
Instructs him the next way to suspect you,
And prompts him to deceive you.

FERDINAND

There's gold.

BOSOLA

So:
What follows? Never rained such showers as these
Without thunderbolts i' the tail of them.
Whose throat must I cut?

FERDINAND

Your inclination to shed blood rides post
Before my occasion to use you. I give you that
To live i' the court here, and observe the Duchess:
To note all the particulars of her 'haviour,
What suitors do solicit her for marriage,
And whom she best affects. She's a young widow:
I would not have her marry again.

BOSOLA

No, sir?

FERDINAND

Do not you ask the reason; but be satisfied.
I say I would not.

BOSOLA

It seems you would create me
One of your familiars.

FERDINAND

Familiar! What's that?

BOSOLA

Why, a very quaint invisible devil in flesh:
An intelligencer.

FERDINAND

Such a kind of thriving thing
I would wish thee, and ere long thou may'st arrive
At a higher place by't.

This extract continues on the next page

BOSOLA

Take your devils,
Which hell calls angels. These cursed gifts would make
You a corrupter, me an impudent traitor;
And should I take these, they'd take me to hell.

FERDINAND

Sir, I'll take nothing from you that I have given.
There is a place that I procured for you
This morning, the provisorship o' the horse;
Have you heard on't?

BOSOLA

No.

FERDINAND

'Tis yours. Is't not worth thanks?

BOSOLA

I would have you curse yourself now, that your bounty,
Which makes men truly noble, e'er should make me
A villain. O, that to avoid ingratitude
For the good deed you have done me, I must do
All the ill man can invent! Thus the devil
Candies all sins o'er; and what heaven terms vile,
That names he complimentary.

Section B: Later dramatic tragedies

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0	6
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Arthur Miller: *Death of a Salesman*

To what extent is the influence of the past in *Death of a Salesman* presented as being wholly destructive?

[25 marks]

or

0	7
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Tennessee Williams: *A Streetcar Named Desire*

‘Blanche’s Southern culture may seem romantic, but in the end it is shown to be tragically flawed.’

To what extent do you agree with this view of the play?

[25 marks]

or

0	8
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Henrik Ibsen: *Hedda Gabler*

How far do you agree with the view that in the tragedy of *Hedda Gabler* Judge Brack is presented simply as a villain?

[25 marks]

or

0	9
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Samuel Beckett: *Waiting for Godot*

What is the tragic and dramatic significance of power (or the lack of it) in *Waiting for Godot*?

[25 marks]

or

1	0
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Brian Friel: *Translations*

Towards the end of the play, Hugh tells Owen: ‘To remember everything is a form of madness.’

To what extent is the past shown to have a tragic and negative influence in *Translations*?

[25 marks]

END OF QUESTIONS

There are no questions printed on this page

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